



# Denis Syla

SOC Analyst · Threat Hunter · Incident Responder

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## Summary

SOC Analyst on the front line of Albania's national cyber defense. Four years hunting threats across government infrastructure: **APT campaigns**, **BEC intrusions**, and **live forensics** on compromised servers. Hands-on across the full incident lifecycle, from detection engineering to formal reporting. Building toward leading a security-focused organization.

## Professional Experience

**Blue Team 10 Participant** March 2026  
NATO Locked Shields 2026 · International live-fire cyber defense exercise

- Threat hunting and incident response in a Trend Micro Vision One XDR environment against simulated nation-state adversaries.
- C2 detection, endpoint telemetry analysis, and alert triage under sustained operational pressure.

**IT Specialist / SOC Analyst** 06/2022 – Present  
AKSHI · National Agency for Information Society · Tirana, Albania

- Monitor, detect and respond to threats on government infrastructure using **MDE, MDO, Vision One, and Dream**.
- Daily threat hunting via KQL Advanced Hunting; DFIR investigations; SPOTREP incident reporting.
- BEC investigations: AiTM token theft, inbox-rule manipulation, MFA-bypass patterns.
- Responded to C2 beacon campaigns, LSASS credential dumping, and lateral movement incidents.
- Vulnerability management with **Rapid7 InsightVM**; attack-surface and third-party risk monitoring with **BitSight**.
- Authored APT threat-intelligence reports: Iranian, Chinese, Russian, North Korean actors.

**Head of IT** 06/2021 – 06/2022  
Brunes SH.P.K · Tirana, Albania

- Domain administration, Group Policy, server monitoring; virtualized environment (Hyper-V, VMware, Proxmox).
- Vulnerability assessments: Cisco ASA, Fortinet, Nessus, NMAP, Wireshark on Kali Linux.

**Helpdesk IT Support** 04/2019 – 08/2020  
Tring · Tirana, Albania

- Technical assistance and helpdesk support focused on network troubleshooting.

## Projects

**fto.al: Albania's events platform** <https://fto.al>  
Built and shipped end-to-end: event invitations from templates, personalized WhatsApp delivery, real-time RSVP tracking with automatic reminders. Developed with an AI-assisted engineering workflow (Claude Code).

## Education

**MSc Business Informatics**  
European University of Tirana · 2018 – 2020

**BSc Finance & Banking**  
Albanian University · 2015 – 2018

## Skills

**Security Tools**  
MDE · MDO · Vision One · Dream · Suricata · Rapid7 InsightVM · BitSight · KQL · SIEM

**Specializations**  
Threat Hunting · Incident Response · DFIR · Malware Analysis · BEC · APT Intelligence

**Networking**  
CCNA · MTCNA · Fortinet · Cisco ASA · VLANs · OSPF · NAT

**Virtualization**  
Proxmox (KVM) · Hyper-V · VMware · Docker

**Cloud & OS**  
Azure · Windows Server · Linux · Kali Linux

**Dev & AI Tooling**  
Python · KQL · C# · Bash · HTML/CSS/JS · Claude Code (AI-assisted engineering) · Workflow automation

## Certifications

**CompTIA Security+**  
CompTIA

**SC-200: Security Operations Analyst**  
Microsoft Certified

**CEH · Certified Ethical Hacker**  
EC-Council

**Advanced Topics in Incident Handling**  
CMU / SEI CERT® · 2024

**CCNA**  
Cisco Systems · Oct 2022

**Cyber Security Professional**  
Albanian ICT Academy · 2023

**Web Design & Development**  
Ministry of Finance · 2019

## Languages

|          |              |
|----------|--------------|
| Albanian | Native       |
| English  | Proficient   |
| Italian  | Intermediate |

## Soft Skills

Decision Making · Collaboration · Initiative · Accountability · Leadership